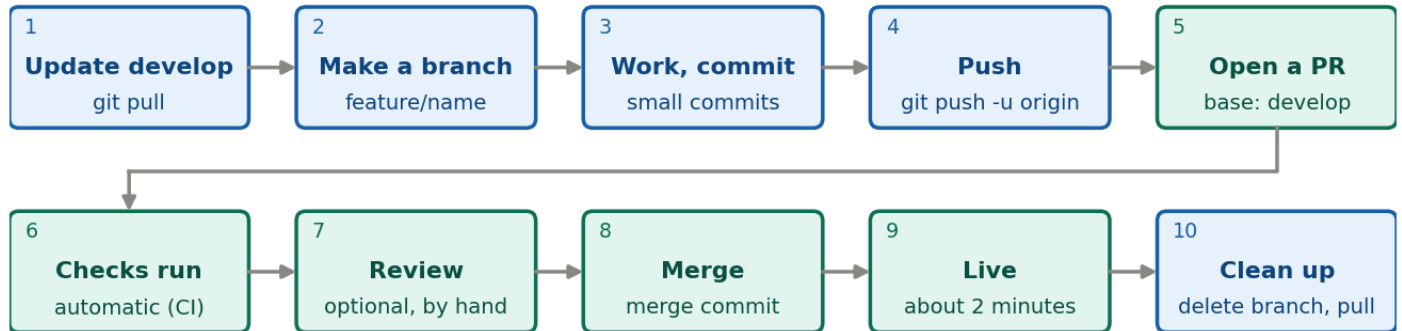


Developer workflow

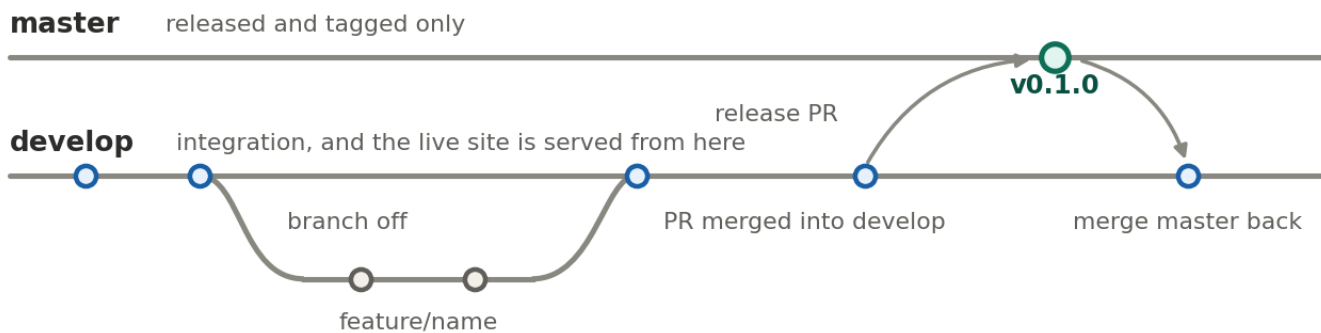
NSDF-Data · Git Flow and semantic versioning · version 1, 7 October 2026

A **pull request (PR)** is a page on GitHub that says “please merge branch X into branch Y”. It shows the changes, runs the automatic checks, and keeps the discussion in one place. **Nothing reaches develop until you press Merge.** develop is where work lands and what the live site is served from; master holds tagged releases only.



The loop for every change. Blue: on your computer. Teal: on GitHub. A check turns red? Fix it on the same branch and push again; the PR updates.

```
git switch develop && git pull           # 1 start from the latest develop
git switch -c feature/my-change          # 2 your branch
git add <files> && git commit -m "What and why" # 3 small commits; update CHANGELOG.md
git push -u origin feature/my-change     # 4
gh pr create --base develop --fill       # 5 or "Compare & pull request" on GitHub
# 6-9: checks run, optional review, press Merge (merge commit), the site updates
git switch develop && git pull && git branch -d feature/my-change # 10
```



Branches over time. A feature merges into develop through a PR. A release goes to master, is tagged, and master is merged back.

Making a release, when there is something to version: branch release/X.Y.Z from develop, set VERSION and date CHANGELOG.md, open a PR into master and merge it, tag vX.Y.Z on the merge commit, merge master back into develop, publish the GitHub release, delete the branch. Bump **major** for a breaking library change (not while 0.x), **minor** for a new capability, **patch** for fixes and content. A guide or site fix is an ordinary feature PR. A **hotfix** is only for a bug in a released version.

Special cases. A *student note*: the PR into develop runs the check only, and nothing is visible; you replace TBD with an S-number and merge, the bot builds the page, and it is live in 2 to 3 minutes (delete the source file to remove a note). A *contributor such as Kitty*: they open a PR into develop, you are requested automatically, and you add other reviewers by hand. An *AI agent*: may open PRs, and never merges without your go-ahead.

Never commit directly to master or develop, and never force-push (the rulesets block both).

Details are in the repository: RELEASING.md, AGENTS.md, CHANGELOG.md.